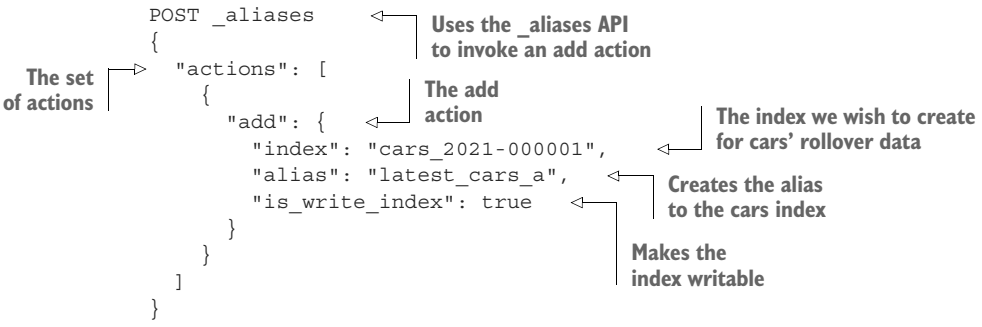
As long as we have a positive integer, Elasticsearch will increment the number and move forward. For example, if we provide `my-index-04` or `my-index-0004`, the next rollover index will be `my-index-000005`. Elasticsearch automatically pads the suffix with zeros.

We go over these steps in the next couple of sections.

Creating an alias for rollover operations

The first thing we need to do before a rollover operation is to create an alias pointing to the index we want to roll over. We can use the rollover API for index or data stream aliases. For example, the following listing invokes the `_aliases` API to create an alias called `latest_cars_a` for the index `cars_2021-000001` (make sure you create this index up front).

Listing 6.45 Creating an alias for an existing index



The `_aliases` API request body expects the `add` action with an index and its alias defined. It creates the alias `latest_cars_a` pointing to an existing index, `cars_2021-000001`, with the `POST` command.

One important point to note: the alias must point to a writable index—hence we set `is_write_index` to `true` in the listing. If the alias points to multiple indexes, at least one must be a writable index. The next step is to roll over the index.

Issuing a rollover operation

Now that we have created an alias, the next step is to invoke the rollover API endpoint. Elasticsearch has defined a `_rollover` API for this purpose.

Listing 6.46 Rolling over the index

```
POST latest_cars_a/_rollover
```

The `_rollover` endpoint is invoked on the alias, not the index. Once the call is successful, a new index, `cars_2021-000002`, is created (*-`000001` is incremented by 1). Here is the response to the call.